



MEMBERSHIP 201: GROWING IN GOD

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Welcome back! In Membership 101, we learned who Metanoya is: our story, our mission, and our beliefs. Today we're going to talk about your spiritual growth.

What is Spiritual Growth?

Spiritual growth means becoming more like Jesus.

"This will continue until we all come to such unity in our faith and knowledge of God's Son that we will be mature in the Lord, measuring up to the full and complete standard of Christ." Ephesians 4:13 (NLT)

Spiritual growth doesn't happen automatically or overnight. It takes time and intentionality. Healthy spiritual habits help us become stronger followers of Jesus. (1 Timothy 4:7–8; 2 Peter 3:18)

The goal of this class is simple:



To help you develop habits that will help you grow spiritually. Today we're going to learn four habits:

GOD'S WORD • PRAYER • TITHING • FELLOWSHIP

1. THE HABIT OF _____

*"¹⁶ All Scripture is inspired by God and is useful to teach us what is true and to make us realize what is wrong in our lives. It corrects us when we are wrong and teaches us to do what is right. ¹⁷ God uses it to prepare and equip his people to do every good work."
2 Timothy 3:16–17 (NLT)*

The Bible teaches us truth, corrects us, shows us how to live, and equips us to follow Jesus.

How Do I Grow in God's Word?

1. _____ the Word.

- ▶ Listen to biblical teaching.
- ▶ *"So faith comes from hearing, that is, hearing the Good News about Christ." Romans 10:17 (NLT)*

2. _____ the Word.

- ▶ Make Bible reading part of your life.
- ▶ *"God blesses the one who reads the words of this prophecy to the church, and he blesses all who listen to its message and obey what it says, for the time is near." Revelation 1:3 (NLT)*

3. _____ the Word.

- ▶ Ask questions and learn what it means.
- ▶ *"And the people of Berea were more open-minded than those in Thessalonica, and they listened eagerly to Paul's message. They searched the Scriptures day after day to see if Paul and Silas were teaching the truth." Acts 17:11 (NLT)*

4. _____ the Word.

- ▶ Store God's truth in your heart.

- ▶ *"I have hidden your word in my heart, that I might not sin against you." Psalm 119:11 (NLT)*

5. _____ on the Word.

- ▶ Think about what you've read.
- ▶ *"I have hidden your word in my heart, that I might not sin against you." Psalm 1:2 (NLT)*

6. _____ the Word.

- ▶ Put God's Word into practice.
- ▶ *"But don't just listen to God's word. You must do what it says. Otherwise, you are only fooling yourselves." James 1:22 (NLT)*



**The goal isn't simply to know more Bible.
THE GOAL IS TO PRACTICE WHAT THE BIBLE TEACHES.**

2. THE HABIT OF _____

"⁶Don't worry about anything; instead, pray about everything. Tell God what you need, and thank him for all he has done. ⁷Then you will experience God's peace, which exceeds anything we can understand. His peace will guard your hearts and minds as you live in Christ Jesus." Philippians 4:6-7 (NLT)

If reading the Bible helps us hear from God, prayer is how we talk with God. Prayer doesn't have to be complicated. Jesus gave us a simple model in Matthew 6:9-13:

1. _____

- ▶ Focus on who God is and thank Him for what He's done.
- ▶ *"Pray like this: Our Father in heaven may your name be kept holy." Matthew 6:9 (NLT)*

2. _____

- ▶ Ask God for His will instead of simply demanding your own.
- ▶ *"May your Kingdom come soon. May your will be done on earth, as it is in heaven." Matthew 6:10 (NLT)*

3. _____

- ▶ Talk to God about your family, struggles, decisions, worries, and needs.
- ▶ *"Give us today the food we need," Matthew 6:11 (NLT)*



**Prayer isn't about using the right words.
It's about developing a real relationship with God.
LEARN TO TALK TO GOD EVERY DAY.**

3. THE HABIT OF _____

“Wherever your treasure is, there the desires of your heart will also be.” Matthew 6:21 (NLT)

Growing spiritually also changes the way we view our money. Jesus taught that our money and our hearts are closely connected.

What Is Tithing?



“Honor the LORD with your wealth and with the best part of everything you produce.” Proverbs 3:9 (NLT)

A tithe is the first ten percent. An offering is generosity beyond the tithe.

Why Do We Tithe?

1. WE _____ GOD.

- ▶ *“Honor the LORD with your wealth and with the best part of everything you produce.” Proverbs 3:9 (NLT)*

2. WE PUT GOD _____.

- ▶ *“Bring this tithe to the designated place of worship—the place the LORD your God chooses for his name to be honored—and eat it there in his presence. This applies to your tithes of grain, new wine, olive oil, and the firstborn males of your flocks and herds.*

*Doing this will teach you always to fear the LORD your God.”
Deuteronomy 14:2 (NLT)*

3. WE REMEMBER THAT _____ COMES FROM GOD.

- ▶ *“Remember the LORD your God. He is the one who gives you power to be successful, in order to fulfill the covenant he confirmed to your ancestors with an oath.”
Deuteronomy 8:18 (NLT)*

4. WE _____ THE WORK OF GOD'S HOUSE.

- ▶ *“Bring all the tithes into the storehouse so there will be enough food in my Temple. If you do,” says the LORD of Heaven’s Armies, “I will open the windows of heaven for you. I will pour out a blessing so great you won’t have enough room to take it in! Try it! Put me to the test!” Malachi 3:10 (NLT)*



Tithing is ultimately about trusting God and putting HIM FIRST.

Where Do I Tithe?

*“Bring all the tithes into the storehouse so there will be enough food in my Temple. If you do,” says the LORD of Heaven’s Armies, “I will open the windows of heaven for you. I will pour out a blessing so great you won’t have enough room to take it in! Try it! Put me to the test!”
Malachi 3:10 (NLT)*

where we worship, grow, serve, and participate in God's mission.

The Metanoya Tithing Challenge

We encourage you to take a six-month tithing challenge: Give the first 10% of your income faithfully for six months and learn to trust God with your finances. This isn't a promise that you'll become rich. It's an invitation to develop the habit of putting God first. Part of being a member of Metanoya Church is tithing.



Note: Have everyone download the Metanoya App and show them where the tithing/giving section is.

4. THE HABIT OF

“And let us not neglect our meeting together, as some people do, but encourage one another, especially now that the day of his return is drawing near.” Hebrews 10:25 (NLT)

Christianity was never meant to be lived alone. We need relationships with other believers who help us follow Jesus.

Why Do I Need Fellowship?

1. WE NEED _____.

- ▶ *"²⁴ Let us think of ways to motivate one another to acts of love and good works. ²⁵ And let us not neglect our meeting together, as some people do, but encourage one another, especially now that the day of his return is drawing near."*
Hebrews 10:24–25 (NLT)
- ▶ We need people who strengthen us.

2. WE NEED _____.

- ▶ *"⁹ Two people are better off than one, for they can help each other succeed. ¹⁰ If one person falls, the other can reach out and help. But someone who falls alone is in real trouble."*
Ecclesiastes 4:9–10 (NLT)
- ▶ We need people who help us when life gets difficult.

3. WE NEED _____.

- ▶ *"Dear brothers and sisters, if another believer is overcome by some sin, you who are godly should gently and humbly help that person back onto the right path. And be careful not to fall into the same temptation yourself. ² Share each other's burdens, and in this way obey the law of Christ."*
Galatians 6:1–2 (NLT)
- ▶ We need people who help us continue following Jesus.



You can attend church in a crowd and still live your life alone!
**THAT'S WHY RELATIONSHIPS WITH OTHER BELIEVERS
MATTER.**

Four Habits That Help Me Grow

| 01 GOD'S WORD: *I hear from God.*

| 02 PRAYER *I talk with God.*

| 03 TITHING: *I put God first.*

| 04 FELLOWSHIP: *I grow with God's family.*



MEMBERSHIP 201 COMMITMENT

MY COMMITMENT TO GROW

“For God is working in you, giving you the desire and the power to do what pleases him.” Philippians 2:13 (NLT)

As I continue growing in my relationship with Jesus, I commit to developing these spiritual habits:

- ☐ **GOD'S WORD** — I will regularly read and apply God's Word.
- ☐ **PRAYER** — I will develop a consistent prayer life.
- ☐ **TITHING** — I will honor God by faithfully giving the first 10% of my income.
- ☐ **FELLOWSHIP** — I will build relationships with other believers & participate in my church family.

Name: _____

Date: ____/____/____